Briefs, research & evaluation

D&M WITH MR KELLY

Higher · Design · Worksheet

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

By the end of this worksheet I can…

- ☐ explain why research is carried out during the design process
- ☐ describe the key stages of a questionnaire
- ☐ describe the key stages of a user trip
- ☐ name the methods used to evaluate products: comparisons, user trials, comparison against the specification, questionnaires
- ☐ explain the purpose of the design brief and compare open and closed briefs
- ☐ explain the difference between primary and secondary research, with examples
- ☐ describe the key stages of surveys, comparisons, tests and test rigs, and user trials
- ☐ explain why existing products are evaluated

I DO — Worked example

Read how a full-mark answer is built

A designer is researching garden furniture.

1 Describe three key stages of carrying out a questionnaire. (3 marks)

Full-mark answer each ✓ is one mark

Decide what information is needed and write a short set of clear questions ✓. Choose the target audience, for example 20 gardeners aged 30–60, and how many to ask ✓. Give it out, collect the answers and analyse them, presenting the results as graphs ✓.

Why marks are not awarded

"Write it, hand it out, get it back."

1 mark: single words or very short stages barely describe anything.

WE DO — Guided practice

Use the starters and word bank to help you

The designer also wants to research existing products.

2 Name an alternative research technique to a questionnaire. (1 mark)

Sentence starters

1. …

Word bank

User trip · user trial · research · comparison · reviews

Tip: 1 marks = 1 separate, developed points.

YOU DO **On your own** No notes. Check your answers afterwards.

3 Quick check: tick one box for each.

a) Who normally carries out a user trip?
☐ A member of the target market ☐ A member of the design team ☐ A retailer ☐ A manufacturer

b) What is the first key stage of a questionnaire?
☐ Trial the questionnaire ☐ Choose closed questions ☐ Identify what information is required ☐ Analyse the results

c) What is a drawback of an open brief for the client?
☐ The designer has no freedom ☐ The client has less control over the final outcome ☐ It always costs less ☐ It cannot be researched

d) A company wants to know if a hinge will survive 10 years of use. Which technique fits best?
☐ Lifestyle board ☐ Test rig ☐ Questionnaire ☐ Product review

4 Key terms: write the letter of the matching description next to each term.

1. **Primary research**	____	**A** Real users test the product in a controlled setting while the designer observes and records interactions.
2. **Secondary research**	____	**B** Information gathered by someone else, e.g. books, journals, product reviews, websites.
3. **Key stages of a questionnaire**	____	**C** Few constraints: gives the designer creative freedom.
4. **User trial**	____	**D** Identify info needed → decide who/how many → choose question types → trial it → distribute, collect, analyse.
5. **Test rig**	____	**E** Information you gather yourself, e.g. questionnaires, user trips, user trials, product comparisons.
6. **Open brief**	____	**F** A machine that repeats an action over and over to simulate extended use in a short time.

5 Describe how a specification is used by a designer during the design process. (2 marks)

A client sets an open design brief for a new garden product.

6 Describe one advantage and one disadvantage to the client of setting an open brief. (2 marks)

A designer is developing a pushchair.

7 Describe the key stages of two research techniques the designer could use. (4 marks)

Check and reflect

Mark your answers with the answer sheet. Go back to the checklist on the site and re-rate each “I can” statement above. Which one still needs work?